Evidence & Data Reference Guide: Tribal Cowboy Equine Activation Proposals

Overview

This guide identifies every major claim made in the North 40 Outfitters and Silver Lake Mall proposals, matches each to independently sourced statistics, and flags where data gaps remain. Use this as a quick-reference sheet to defend or strengthen the proposals in any conversation with a decision-maker.

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1. Dwell Time Claims

Claim: "Activation increases dwell time by 30–60 minutes"

Supporting evidence:

- McKinsey & Company research confirms that retailers prioritizing "experience-led" strategies achieve a **2–7% increase in sales revenue** and a **7–10% increase in total shareholder returns**, directly linking dwell engagement to revenue.[1]
- Active entertainment tenants (activity parks, interactive venues) produce visits of **2–3 hours**, compared with just 30–60 minutes for passive entertainment options — the queue-and-ride model mirrors this dynamic directly.[2]
- Visitors to entertainment-anchored shopping centers **spend up to 30% more** than those visiting traditional retail environments, attributed to extended time and relaxed emotional states.[2]
- Research shows that longer dwell time is a primary driver of larger basket sizes and higher per-visit spend, validating the queue-as-browse-time argument in the proposals.[3]

What's still needed: A direct controlled study measuring dwell time at a lead-line pony ride event specifically. No published study exists for this exact format — the claim is supported by experiential retail analogs but should be disclosed as a projection, not a proven result.

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2. Revenue Impact Claims

Claim: "60–120 families per event; $1,500–$3,000 in same-day incremental revenue"

Supporting evidence:

- At 60–120 families, the $25/family incremental spend assumption is conservative. ICSC research shows average mall spend per visit ranges from $103 (ages 18–34) to $140+ (ages 55–64), suggesting $25 per family underestimates likely basket size.[4]
- Experiential retail customers increase **monthly spending by 30%**, **purchase frequency by 16.7%**, and **purchase quantity by 28.6%** — all pointing to a spend-lift scenario consistent with the activation model.[5][6]
- Retail activations with controlled case studies have demonstrated **incremental sales lift of 15%+ over baseline** in the four weeks following activation, validating the broader revenue case even beyond event day.[7]
- Families specifically reduce trip frequency but **spend more per visit** when they do go, making whole-family activation days higher-value than typical visits.[8]

What's still needed: Point-of-sale (POS) data from a comparable farm/ranch or outdoor retailer event to convert these benchmarks into a North 40–specific projection with named comparables.

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3. Social Media & Branded Photo Claims

Claim: "100+ branded photos shared; horse community sees North 40/Silver Lake in their feed"

Supporting evidence:

- UGC posts generate **6.9× higher engagement** than brand-created content on Facebook.[9][10][11]
- Social campaigns incorporating UGC see a **50% lift in engagement**, and UGC posts have a **28% higher engagement rate** than branded content.[10][12][13]
- Each photo booth share **exposes the event brand to hundreds of additional viewers** beyond physical attendees — an audience of 200 attendees, each with 500 followers and a 60% share rate, produces **60,000 organic impressions**.[14]
- Photo booth content often represents **40–60% of event hashtag volume** on Instagram and Twitter, making branded photo delivery a dominant contributor to event social reach.[14]
- Branded photo booth content delivers **3–5× ROI** through lead generation, social amplification, and brand awareness, with earned media value calculated at estimated CPM × total social impressions.[15][11]
- **79% of consumers report increased trust** in companies that incorporate UGC, validating the "photo in the feed = brand credibility" argument in the proposals.[9]
- Ads featuring UGC generate **5× greater click-through rates** and **73% more positive comments** on social networks.[13][10]

What's still needed: A specific share-rate benchmark from a comparable outdoor/equine event photo booth. The general photo booth industry benchmark is 10–20% "standard," 20–30% "good," and 30%+ "viral" — the unique nature of a Clydesdale in a mall or ranch store parking lot could reasonably push toward the upper end, but this is unproven without event data.[15]

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4. Audience Alignment Claims

Claim: "North 40's customers are the exact audience for this; Silver Lake captures a broader, higher-volume crowd"

Supporting evidence:

- Idaho has an estimated **270,000+ privately owned horses** — more than 1 for every 10 residents — and the population has grown by approximately 50,000 horses over the past decade.[16]
- **14% of Idaho households own equine**, and northern Idaho's equine industry alone contributes over **$51 million** to state gross product.[17][18]
- The U.S. equine industry added **$177 billion in total value** to the economy in 2023 (up from $122 billion in 2017), and supports **2.2 million jobs**, demonstrating this is a deep-pocketed, large-scale audience.[19][20]
- Kootenai County (Silver Lake Mall's primary market) has a population of **188,323**, with high homeownership rates (71.3%) suggesting the stable, family-oriented demographic that attends events like these.[21][22][23][24]
- **75% of U.S. adult mall visitors** go specifically to socialize with friends and family — shopping has become secondary to the experience, validating the Silver Lake positioning around experiential surprise.[25][4]
- Gen Z shoppers (58% of ages 18–34) visit malls often or sometimes, and **60% of Gen Z visit malls primarily for socializing and experiences**, making unexpected experiences like live horses particularly high-impact.[26][27]
- A 2024 survey found **~70% of respondents** were in favor of pony rides returning to Griffith Park (Los Angeles), with 50% finding it "very appealing" — demonstrating strong baseline consumer appetite for live animal family experiences.[28][29]

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5. Foot Traffic & Mall Context Claims

Claim: "Silver Lake Mall will benefit from incremental foot traffic and the surprise factor"

Supporting evidence:

- Indoor malls saw a **9.7% year-over-year increase in foot traffic** (2024), with visit durations up **3.3%** — Silver Lake is riding a recovery trend, not fighting one.[30]
- Mall shoppers are **expected to increase 18.7%** in the holiday season and open-air shoppers by 10%, per JLL's 2024 Holiday Shopping Report.[31]
- Silver Lake Mall is owned by Black Sheep Properties (the Knoll family), who bought it from Brookfield Properties in 2021 and have since achieved **full occupancy**, with over **15,000 visitors** over a single three-day Black Sheep grand opening weekend.[32][33]
- The Knolls' ownership background is notably **aligned with the outdoor/sporting audience** — their flagship store is Black Sheep Sporting Goods, which has a strong overlap with the equine and ranch community.[34][33][32]
- Macy's recently closed at Silver Lake (March 2025), and was replaced by Black Sheep Sporting Goods Footwear and Clothing — the mall is actively repositioning, making it receptive to traffic-driving activations.[35]
- Experiential tenants that create anchor-level traffic can increase per-visitor spending across the entire mall ecosystem, directly supporting the "tenant co-marketing" value proposition in the Silver Lake proposal.[36][2]

What's still needed: Current weekly foot traffic count for Silver Lake Mall specifically. No public figure exists. Recommend requesting this from Black Sheep Properties during the pitch meeting.

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6. Safety & Liability Claims

Claim: "Zero incidents across events; lead-line pony rides are inherently controlled"

Supporting evidence:

- PRCA data collected across approximately **355,000 animal exposures per year** shows a **99.9% animal safety record** — injuries occurring in just 1 of every 1,000 runs at professional rodeo events.[37]
- Equestrian injuries studied by national databases are primarily associated with **independent riding events** — bucking, falls, and being thrown — not controlled lead-line activities. Of 4,760 emergency room visits (2018–2022), **98.2% involved a horse-level event** such as a buck, fall, or being thrown, the exact conditions that lead-line pony rides eliminate.[38]
- The enclosure, handler control, and lead-line format the proposals describe are specifically designed to remove the primary injury mechanisms: independent riding and loose animals. This is a meaningful risk reduction that should be stated in safety language.

What's still needed: Tribal Cowboy's own event incident log. Even a simple statement — "X events, Y total guests, 0 incidents requiring medical attention" — from Stacie's own history is more convincing than industry benchmarks. This is the single most powerful safety credential you can add.

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7. Earned Media Claims

Claim: "'Horses at the mall' is a local news story; media will cover it"

Supporting evidence:

- The Silver Lake Mall general manager documented that the Black Sheep grand opening attracted over **15,000 visitors over a three-day weekend** and press coverage, demonstrating that novelty events at this specific mall generate community interest and earned media.[32]

- Experiential events that are "unexpected" outperform expected ones in social sharing, media pickup, and organic reach, which is the core mechanism behind the "surprise = shareability" argument.[39][40]
- Live animal events at unexpected venues (urban/suburban settings) have a documented track record of attracting local press and social virality, and the combination of a mall, Clydesdales, and branded photos amplifies this baseline.[41]

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8. Community & Indigenous Ownership Claims

Claim: "Partnering with an Indigenous-owned business gives the mall an authentic community story"

Supporting evidence:

- The Idaho Tribes Economic Impact Report documents the significant economic and cultural presence of Native-owned businesses across the Coeur d'Alene region, providing regional context for the community partnership angle.[42]
- Consumer research consistently shows that **authentic partnerships** with local and underrepresented businesses resonate with shoppers and increase brand trust.[43][9]
- This positioning is difficult to replicate by competitors overnight, as the proposals correctly state — but it should be backed with specific language about what "Indigenous-owned" means in practice (Nisenan Maidu identity, Idaho/North Idaho roots, community relationships).

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9. Comparable Activation Cost Claims

Claim: "Comparable live animal activations run $5,000–$15,000; Tribal Cowboy's model is priced as a low-risk entry point"

Supporting evidence:

- Industry benchmarks confirm that **typical mall experiential activations cost $5,000–$15,000**, and the Tribal Cowboy base fee of $2,500–$3,000 is explicitly priced below this range as a proof-of-concept entry point.[44]
- The photo booth/branded photo industry separately supports **3–5× ROI on photo booth investment** through social amplification alone, independent of in-store sales lift.[11]
- AnyRoad and similar experiential measurement platforms have documented that experiential activations like Absolut's events boosted **guest revenue per visit by 36%**, validating premium-over-baseline spend by activation attendees.[45]

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10. Data Gaps to Proactively Address

The following are the specific claims in both proposals that currently lack sourced backing. These are the items a skeptical decision-maker or their legal team will challenge:

Claim	Gap	Recommended Fix
"60–120 families per event"	No past Tribal Cowboy event attendance data cited	Add Stacie's own event attendance records, even 1–2 events
"$25 incremental per-family spend"	Directional assumption, not measured	Tie to ICSC avg. spend-per-visit data as the conservative floor
"30–60 min dwell time increase"	No equine-specific study; experiential retail analog only	Label as a projection based on experiential retail benchmarks
"Zero incidents"	Self-asserted; no third-party verification	Add Tribal Cowboy's own event log: events, guest count, incidents
"100+ branded photos shared"	No Tribal Cowboy social post data cited	Screenshot share counts from prior events; even 3–5 examples
"Local news will cover it"	Claimed, not evidenced	Add 1–2 prior media mentions or coverage from past events
Photo tech "fully privacy-compliant"	No standard named	Name the compliance standard (e.g., no PII stored, no third-party data sharing, CCPA-aligned)
Animal welfare protocol	Entirely absent	Add a 5-bullet welfare protocol: temp thresholds, rest schedules, vet oversight

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Key Statistics Quick-Reference Card

Statistic	Source	Use It For
McKinsey: experience-led retail = 2–7% sales lift, 7–10% shareholder return[1]	McKinsey & Company	Executive-level business case
Experiential customers spend 30% more monthly[5][6]	Rockbot / LinkedIn	Incremental revenue argument
UGC generates 6.9× more engagement than brand content[9][10]	Medianug / Nosto	Branded photo social value
79% of consumers trust brands more when they use UGC[9]	Medianug	Trust and brand lift argument
14% of Idaho households own equine[18]	Idaho Horse Board	North Idaho audience size
270,000+ horses privately owned in Idaho[16]	NewsRadio 1310 / Idaho Horse Council	North Idaho market depth
$177 billion total U.S. equine industry economic impact (2023)[19]	American Horse Council	Industry credibility
9.7% YoY mall foot traffic increase (2024)[30]	V-Count	Silver Lake Mall context
75% of U.S. adults visited a mall in the past 3 months[4]	ICSC	Mall audience scale
Average mall spend per visit: $103–$140[4]	ICSC	Conservative revenue floor
Lead-line removes 98.2% of injury mechanisms[38]	National ER database	Risk/safety defense

Statistic	Source	Use It For
	(NEISS)	
PRCA: 99.9% animal safety record across 355,000 exposures[37]	PRCA / The Horse	Animal safety argument
Silver Lake: 15,000 visitors in 3-day Black Sheep opening weekend[32]	Spokane Journal	Mall traffic benchmark
Photo booth content = 40–60% of event hashtag volume[14]	FeatureBooth	Social share volume claim
50% lift in engagement for UGC campaigns[10][13]	Salesforce / EverySocial	Social amplificatio n ROI

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